



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Owning Your Faith: A Study Workbook

Moving From Inherited Belief to Personal, Living Faith - For New & Growing Believers, Ages 13-19

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Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

There comes a point when faith has to stop being your parents' or your church's and start being yours. This six-unit study is for teens and young adults ready to own their faith: making it personal, growing up spiritually, living it in real relationships and culture, discovering purpose, and living sent. For ages 13 to 19.

2 TIMOTHY 3:14

"Continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Making It Personal

"Whoever has the Son has life." - 1 John 5:12

Unit Overview

You can grow up around faith without ever making it your own. This unit is about the difference between inherited belief and personal faith.

DEVOTIONAL

Inherited or Owned?

Faith can't be passed down like a family recipe. At some point it has to become yours.

ROMANS 8:15

"For you did not receive a spirit that makes you a slave again to fear, but the Spirit you received brought about your adoption to sonship."

Growing up in a Christian home is a gift, but God has no grandchildren - only children. Faith has to be personal.

Owning your faith doesn't mean throwing out what you were taught; it means truly making it your own conviction.

Reflect

1. Is your faith currently more inherited or more owned?

2. What would it look like to make it truly yours?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, I don't want a borrowed faith. Help me make it my own.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Choose This Day

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOSHUA 24:14-15

"Now fear the Lord and serve him with all faithfulness... But if serving the Lord seems undesirable to you, then choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve... But as for me and my household, we will serve the Lord."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Joshua call the people to do?

2. What choice does he lay before them?

3. What does Joshua personally decide?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Choose This Day

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Joshua force a clear choice?

2. What does 'as for me' show about owning your decision?

Application - What will I do?

1. Have you personally chosen to follow God?

2. What would a real decision look like for you?

WORD STUDY

Faith

MEANING

Personal trust in and reliance on God - not just believing facts, but entrusting your life to him.

Where It Appears**1 JOHN 5:12**

"Whoever has the Son has life; whoever does not have the Son of God does not have life."

ACTS 16:31

"Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved."

Dig Deeper

1. What's the difference between believing about Jesus and trusting him?

2. Where are you in that difference right now?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Faith Story


How did you first encounter faith?


Where are you in your own journey right now?


What would owning your faith require of you?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

What If I Have Doubts?

THE QUESTION

Can you own a faith you still have questions about?

Think It Through**Doubt isn't the opposite of faith**

Unbelief that refuses to seek is; honest doubt that seeks can deepen faith.

Bring questions to God

God isn't threatened by your questions; hiding them is what hurts faith.

Faith and understanding grow together

You don't need every answer to take a real step of trust.

Your Response

1. What doubts do you need to stop hiding?

2. Who could help you explore them honestly?

UNIT 2

Growing Up Spiritually

"Grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ." - 2 Peter 3:18

Unit Overview

Faith is meant to mature. This unit explores what spiritual growth looks like and the practices that fuel it.

DEVOTIONAL

From Milk to Solid Food

There's nothing wrong with being a spiritual beginner - but there's a problem with staying one forever.

HEBREWS 5:13-14

"Anyone who lives on milk, being still an infant, is not acquainted with the teaching about righteousness... But solid food is for the mature."

Spiritual growth isn't automatic with time; it comes through use and practice, like building strength.

Maturity means moving from being spoon-fed to feeding yourself and eventually feeding others.

Reflect

1. Where are you in your spiritual growth - infant, growing, maturing?

2. What would help you 'grow up' in faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me grow up spiritually and not stay stuck.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Marks of Growth

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

2 PETER 1:5-8

"For this very reason, make every effort to add to your faith goodness; and to goodness, knowledge; and to knowledge, self-control; and to self-control, perseverance; and to perseverance, godliness; and to godliness, mutual affection; and to mutual affection, love. For if you possess these qualities in increasing measure, they will keep you from being ineffective."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to 'make every effort' to do?

2. List the qualities to add.

3. What do these qualities prevent?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Marks of Growth

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Peter say to 'make every effort' if growth is God's work?

2. How do these qualities build on each other?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which quality do you most need to grow in?

2. What effort could you make this week?

WORD STUDY

Maturity

MEANING

Spiritual growth toward Christlikeness in character, wisdom, and love.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 4:13**

"Until we all reach... maturity, attaining to the whole measure of the fullness of Christ."

HEBREWS 6:1

"Let us move beyond the elementary teachings about Christ and be taken forward to maturity."

Dig Deeper

1. What does spiritual maturity look like in someone you admire?

2. What's one next step toward maturity for you?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Growth Plan


Where have you grown spiritually in the past year?


Where are you stuck?


What practice would help you grow?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Growth happens best in community. Discuss it.

1. What helps people actually grow spiritually?

2. What keeps people stuck as spiritual 'infants'?

3. How can this group spur each other's growth?

UNIT 3

Faith in Real Relationships

"By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another." -
John 13:35

Unit Overview

Faith is tested most in relationships. This unit covers friendship, family, dating, and conflict from a Christian perspective.

DEVOTIONAL

Love Is the Test

Jesus said the mark of his followers wouldn't be their arguments or their reputation - but their love.

JOHN 13:34

"A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another."

It's easy to be 'spiritual' alone. Relationships reveal whether faith is real - through patience, forgiveness, and honesty.

The people closest to you experience your actual character, not your online image.

Reflect

1. Where are your relationships testing your faith right now?

2. How does the way you treat people reflect your faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, let my love for people show that I belong to you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

What Love Looks Like

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 CORINTHIANS 13:4-7

"Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It does not dishonor others, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no record of wrongs. Love does not delight in evil but rejoices with the truth. It always protects, always trusts, always hopes, always perseveres."

Observation - What does it say?

1. List what love is.

2. List what love is not.

3. What does love 'always' do?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

What Love Looks Like

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Which of these is hardest to live out?

2. How is this different from how culture defines love?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which relationship needs this kind of love from you?

2. Where do you keep a 'record of wrongs'?

WORD STUDY

Love (Agape)

MEANING

Selfless, committed love that seeks another's good regardless of feelings or return.

Where It Appears**JOHN 15:13**

"Greater love has no one than this: to lay down one's life for one's friends."

1 JOHN 4:10

"This is love: not that we loved God, but that he loved us."

Dig Deeper

1. How is agape different from romantic or friendly feelings?

2. Who in your life is hard to love this way?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Relationships


Which relationship is hardest for you right now?


How would Jesus have you handle it?


What's one loving step you could take?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Love in Action

Love is proven in action, not words. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Forgive someone who wronged you.
- ☐ Have a hard conversation with honesty and kindness.
- ☐ Serve a family member without being asked.
- ☐ Love someone who's hard to love this week.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

Standing Firm in Culture

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed." - Romans 12:2

Unit Overview

Teens are immersed in messages that contradict faith. This unit builds discernment and conviction for living differently.

DEVOTIONAL

Swimming Upstream

Following Jesus often means going against the current - of your culture, your peers, sometimes your own desires.

ROMANS 12:2

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind."

Culture constantly forms us, usually without our noticing. Transformation means letting God renew our thinking instead.

You can't help being influenced; you can choose what shapes you most.

Reflect

1. What cultural messages most shape how you think?

2. Where do you feel pressure to 'conform'?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, renew my mind so I'm shaped by you, not just my culture.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

In the World, Not of It

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 17:15-18

"My prayer is not that you take them out of the world but that you protect them from the evil one. They are not of the world, even as I am not of it. Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth... As you sent me into the world, I have sent them into the world."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Jesus not pray for?

2. What does he pray for instead?

3. What sanctifies (sets apart) his followers?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

In the World, Not of It

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why doesn't Jesus want us removed from the world?

2. How does truth protect and set apart?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where are you tempted to either hide from or blend into culture?

2. How can you be 'sent' into it without being 'of' it?

WORD STUDY

Discernment

MEANING

The ability to distinguish truth from error and good from evil, guided by God's word.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 5:21**

"Test everything; hold on to what is good."

HEBREWS 5:14

"Solid food is for the mature, who... have trained themselves to distinguish good from evil."

Dig Deeper

1. How do you currently decide what's true and good?

2. Where do you need more discernment?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

What Shapes Me


What voices influence you most (media, friends, etc.)?


Where do they conflict with your faith?


How could you renew your mind in that area?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Isn't It Intolerant to Say You're Right?

THE QUESTION

How can Christians hold convictions without being arrogant?

Think It Through**Everyone has convictions**

Even 'all views are equal' is itself a firm claim about truth.

Truth and kindness together

Holding a belief firmly and treating people with respect aren't opposites.

Humble confidence

Jesus was full of both grace and truth - we can be too.

Your Response

1. How can you hold convictions with humility and love?

2. Where have you seen this done well or poorly?

UNIT 5

Discovering Your Purpose

"For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works." -
Ephesians 2:10

Unit Overview

Teens constantly ask 'What am I here for?' This unit explores calling, gifts, and living with purpose.

DEVOTIONAL

Made for a Reason

You're not an accident or a spare part. You were made on purpose, for a purpose.

EPHESIANS 2:10

"For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do."

You're God's 'handiwork' - a work of art with intention behind it. Your life has design and direction.

Purpose isn't mainly about a career; it's about who you're becoming and how you serve God and others.

Reflect

1. Have you felt purposeless or aimless? When?

2. How does being God's intentional 'handiwork' change that?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me discover and live the purpose you made me for.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Different Gifts, One Body

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ROMANS 12:4-6

"For just as each of us has one body with many members, and these members do not all have the same function, so in Christ we, though many, form one body, and each member belongs to all the others. We have different gifts, according to the grace given to each of us."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is the body compared to?

2. Do all members have the same function?

3. Where do our gifts come from?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Different Gifts, One Body

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does the body need different gifts?

2. What happens if someone doesn't use their gift?

Application - What will I do?

1. What gifts or strengths do you have?

2. How could you use them to serve?

WORD STUDY

Calling

MEANING

God's purpose for your life - both the general call to follow Christ and specific ways to serve.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 4:1**

"Live a life worthy of the calling you have received."

COLOSSIANS 3:23

"Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord."

Dig Deeper

1. What might God be calling you toward, even now?

2. How can everyday work be done 'for the Lord'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Purpose

What are you passionate about?

What are you good at?

How might God want to use those to serve others?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Purpose is discovered in community and service.

1. Why do so many people feel aimless?

2. How is Christian purpose different from just 'finding yourself'?

3. How can this group help each other use their gifts?

UNIT 6

Living Sent

"Go and make disciples of all nations." - Matthew 28:19

Unit Overview

Faith isn't meant to be kept to yourself. This unit is about living as someone sent to reflect and share Jesus - the culmination of owning your faith.

DEVOTIONAL

You Are Sent

Owning your faith isn't the finish line; it's the starting line for a life that points others to Jesus.

MATTHEW 28:19-20

"Therefore go and make disciples of all nations... And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age."

Jesus' final command wasn't 'keep this to yourself'; it was 'go.' You're sent right where you are.

You don't have to be an expert. You just have to point people to the One who changed you - and he's with you.

Reflect

1. Who in your life doesn't know Jesus?

2. What holds you back from sharing your faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me live sent - reflecting and sharing you wherever I am.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Salt and Light

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 5:13-16

"You are the salt of the earth... You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden. Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What two things does Jesus call his followers?

2. What's the point of salt and light?

3. What's the goal of shining?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Salt and Light

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What happens to salt or light that's hidden?

2. How is influence different from being preachy?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where could your life be 'salt and light'?

2. How can your good deeds point to God, not you?

WORD STUDY

Mission

MEANING

The sending of God's people into the world to reflect and share the good news of Jesus.

Where It Appears**JOHN 20:21**

"As the Father has sent me, I am sending you."

ACTS 1:8

"You will be my witnesses."

Dig Deeper

1. How does knowing you're 'sent' change ordinary days?

2. What's one way you could live 'on mission' this week?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Living Sent

What's the most important thing you've learned in this study?

How will you live your faith more openly?

Write a prayer committing to follow and share Jesus.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

The final discussion of the book. You are sent.

1. What's the biggest thing you're taking from this study?

2. How will you keep growing and living your faith?

3. How can this group keep encouraging each other's mission?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

1 JOHN 5:12

"1 John 5:12"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: 1 John 5:12

Write out from memory: 2 Peter 3:18

Write out from memory: John 13:35

Write out from memory: Romans 12:2

Write out from memory: Ephesians 2:10

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
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REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection



How has your faith become more your own through this study?



What's your plan to keep growing?



Write a prayer owning your faith and committing to follow Jesus.

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Study Notes

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